

Foundations

Design guidelines · Parent Guidance · Updated October 2, 2026

Every value lives in `tokens.css` as a CSS variable (`--pg-navy`) and as a Tailwind class (`bg-pg-navy` , `text-pg-slate` ...). In inline styles or `motion` props, use the variable: `style={{ boxShadow: "var(--pg-shadow-card)" }}` , `animate={{ backgroundColor: "var(--pg-teal)" }}` .

1.1 Palette

Brand

Token	Hex	Tailwind	Use
Navy	 <code>#1c3243</code>	<code>pg-navy</code>	Headings, primary text, navigation, dark backgrounds, active chip
Navy hover	 <code>#284054</code>	<code>pg-navy-hover</code>	Hover on navy elements
Slate	 <code>#435766</code>	<code>pg-slate</code>	Body text, descriptions, interface icons
Teal	 <code>#59797d</code>	<code>pg-teal</code>	Action color: Primary buttons, links, active icons, selection ring
Teal dark	 <code>#406064</code>	<code>pg-teal-dark</code>	Hover/pressed for teal actions; small accent text (eyebrows, links, metadata)
Sage	 <code>#90b3b6</code>	<code>pg-sage</code>	Decorative accent: color blocks, section-title side bar, large icons, search icons
Mist	 <code>#acbcb6</code>	<code>pg-mist</code>	Decorative elements only ("•" separators with <code>aria-hidden</code> , inactive dots). Never text
Amber	 <code>#c8893a</code>	<code>pg-amber</code>	Lesson accent; decorative fill only
Live	 <code>#52bd95</code>	<code>pg-live</code>	"Live" dot; decorative only

Surfaces and borders

Token	Hex	Tailwind	Use
Cream	 <code>#f9f4f1</code>	<code>pg-cream</code>	Default page background; search fields on white bars
Cream dark	 <code>#f0edeb</code>	<code>pg-cream-dark</code>	Inactive chips, "Featured" button, dividers on cream
White	 <code>#ffffff</code>	<code>white</code>	Cards, panels, filter bars, inputs
Tint	 <code>#eaf1f1</code>	<code>pg-tint</code>	Soft surfaces: badges, date blocks, selected state

Token	Hex	Tailwind	Use
Tint soft	 #f0f6f6	pg-tint-soft	Background of listing sections; row hover
Line	 #dee8e9	pg-line	Borders of cards and inputs, dividers

States

Used in badges, notices and validation. They meet AA on white and cream.

State	Text / icon	Soft background	Where it is used
Success	 #2f7a5f pg-success	 #e6f2ec pg-success-soft	"Guide" badge (with navy text)
Warning	 #8a5a1c pg-warning	 #f7eddc pg-warning-soft	"Worksheet" badge, Ask a Therapist legal notice
Error	 #b42318 pg-error	 #fdecea pg-error-soft	"Tool" badge, form errors

`pg-success` on `pg-success-soft` gives 4.49:1: for small text use **navy** on the green background and keep green for the icon.

Approved contrast combinations

Text	Background	Ratio	Allowed for
Navy	White / Cream / Tint / Line / Sage	5.9–13.2	Everything
Slate	White / Cream / Tint	6.6–7.5	Everything
Teal	White	4.7	Everything
Teal	Cream / Tint	4.1–4.3	Only text ≥ 18px or ≥ 14px bold; for small text use Teal dark
Teal dark	White / Cream / Tint	6.0–6.8	Everything
White	Teal / Teal dark / Navy	4.7 / 6.8 / 13.2	Everything (buttons, badges, dark blocks)
Sage	Navy	5.9	Secondary text and accents on dark backgrounds
Sage / Mist	White / Cream	2.0–2.3	Never as text
White	Sage	2.3	Never: on sage, text and badges are navy

Highlighted blocks

A banner or CTA **inside** a section must stand out from its background: `pg-sage` (navy text, Inverse button), `pg-navy` (white or sage text, Inverse button) or a white card with a `pg-line` border and the

card shadow. Never `pg-tint` on `pg-tint-soft` or `pg-cream-dark` on `pg-cream` (1.04:1, the block disappears).

1.2 Typography

Poppins is the only typeface (400, 500, 600 and 700). It is applied once on `body` (`tokens.css`) and every element inherits it, including buttons and inputs: **do not add font classes**. No `font-black` or `font-light` either: Poppins is only loaded in 400–700.

Scale

Token	Mobile → desktop	Tailwind	Weight	Use
<code>display</code>	38 → 50px	<code>text-[38px]</code> <code>md:text-[50px]</code>	700	Main headline of the home pages (one per page)
<code>h1</code>	28 → 40px	<code>text-[28px]</code> <code>md:text-[40px]</code>	700 (500 in V2)	Page title; titles of featured sections with a colored background ("Need Help Now?", "Join Us!")
<code>h2</code>	24px	<code>text-2xl</code>	700	Section title, banners
<code>h3</code>	20px	<code>text-xl</code>	600–700	Block and panel titles, section labels with a sage bar ("Resource Library"), FAQ questions
<code>h4</code>	16px	<code>text-base</code>	700	Card title
<code>body-lg</code>	16px	<code>text-base</code>	400	Introductions and featured paragraphs
<code>body</code>	14px	<code>text-sm</code>	400	Default text , buttons, inputs
<code>small</code>	12px	<code>text-xs</code>	400–600	Metadata, captions, chips, field hints
<code>eyebrow</code>	11px	<code>text-[11px]</code> <code>uppercase</code>	600	Kicker above headings, date labels ("JUL")

Rules:

- **12px minimum**; 11px only for UPPERCASE text (eyebrows, months in date blocks).
- No in-between sizes outside the scale (13, 15, 18, 22, 30, 36px...): use the nearest step.
- Brand emphasis in headlines: one word or phrase in teal *italics* ("Discover *Resources...*"), without changing the size.
- About 70 characters per line maximum in long paragraphs (`max-w-pg-reading` , 680px).

1.3 Spacing

Tailwind's 4px scale is used. Allowed steps:

Tailwind	px	Typical use
<code>1</code> / <code>1.5</code>	4 / 6	Icon ↔ small text

Tailwind	px	Typical use
2	8	Gap between inline elements, icon ↔ label, between chips
3	12	Gap in compact lists and filter bars
4	16	Card padding, gap between fields
5 / 6	20 / 24	Panel padding, grid gap, mobile gutter
8	32	Space between blocks
10 / 14	40 / 56	Page side gutter (md / lg)
14 / 16 / 20	56 / 64 / 80	Section vertical padding

Avoid loose in-between values (`py-3.5` , `px-2.5`) except for optical adjustments inside components.

1.4 Radii

Token	Value	Tailwind	Use
sm	4px	<code>rounded-pg-sm</code>	Checkboxes, minimal elements
md	8px	<code>rounded-pg-md</code>	Buttons , inputs, selects, "Featured" button
lg	12px	<code>rounded-pg-lg</code>	Small panels, dropdown menus, date blocks
xl	16px	<code>rounded-pg-xl</code>	Cards , pop-ups, banners
2xl	28px	<code>rounded-pg-2xl</code>	Heroes, featured video, section blocks with a background
full	9999px	<code>rounded-full</code>	Chips, badges, avatars, dots, pill-shaped search bars

In the shadcn theme `rounded-lg` is 10px and `rounded-xl` 14px, so the `rounded-pg-*` tokens are always used.

1.5 Shadows

Every shadow is **navy-tinted** (`rgba(28,50,67,...)`), never black.

Token	Value	Use
card	<code>0 8px 24px rgba(28,50,67,0.06)</code>	Cards, filter bars, selected controls
card-hover	<code>0 8px 24px rgba(28,50,67,0.14)</code>	Interactive cards on hover; navbar on scroll
overlay	<code>0 24px 60px rgba(28,50,67,0.28)</code>	Pop-ups, modals, floating menus

Cards use a `pg-line border + card shadow`. To make something stand out, don't stack stronger shadows: use the background color (tint, sage or navy).

1.6 Icons

- Library: **Material Icons, Outlined style** (`@mui/icons-material`). Other styles (Filled, Rounded, Sharp) and other libraries are not mixed in.
- Always import from `src/app/components/icons.tsx` , never straight from `@mui/icons-material` :
`import { Search } from "../components/icons"` . If an icon is missing, add it there using its `Outlined` version.
- Size with `size` in px: 14–16px in controls and 18–20px in icon-only buttons (`<Search size={16} aria-hidden="true" />`).
- Color via `currentColor` plus a text class (`text-pg-slate` , `text-pg-sage` ...), never a hex in the SVG.
- Decorative icons get `aria-hidden="true"` ; icon-only buttons get an `aria-label` .
- Exception: SVG logos (Parent Guidance, partners, social networks) keep their brand colors.